

Genesis 1:5 - Hebrew Handwriting & Reading Practice

Learn the word, say every letter name, notice what each mark does, then write it.

וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹהִים לְאוֹר יוֹם וּלְחֹשֶׁךְ קָרָא לַיְלָה וַיְהִי־עֶרֶב וַיְהִי־בֹקֶר יוֹם אֶחָד:

Pronunciation: vai-YIK-rah eh-lo-HEEM lah-OR yohm, veh-la-KHO-shekh kah-RAH LIE-lah; vai-yeh-HEE EH-rev, vai-yeh-HEE VOH-ker, yohm eh-KHAHD.

Meaning: And God called the light Day, and the darkness He called Night. And there was evening and there was morning, one day.

Word order

#	Hebrew	Transliteration	Pronunciation	Meaning
1	וַיִּקְרָא	vayyiqra	vai-YIK-rah	and He called / named
2	אֱלֹהִים	Elohim	eh-lo-HEEM	God
3	לְאוֹר	la'or	lah-OR	to the light
4	יוֹם	yom	yohm	day
5	וּלְחֹשֶׁךְ	velachoshekh	veh-la-KHO-shekh	and the darkness
6	קָרָא	qara	kah-RAH	He called / named
7	לַיְלָה	laylah	LIE-lah	night
8	וַיְהִי־עֶרֶב	vayehi-erev	vai-yeh-HEE EH-rev	and there was evening
9	וַיְהִי־בֹקֶר	vayehi-voqer	vai-yeh-HEE VOH-ker	and there was morning
10	יוֹם	yom	yohm	day
11	אֶחָד	echad	eh-KHAHD	one

Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 1

וַיִּקְרָא

Transliteration	vayyiqra
Pronunciation	vai-YIK-rah
Meaning	and He called / named
From / dictionary form	קרא qara - to call / proclaim / name

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
וּ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
יְ	Yod	y / helper	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound. Dagesh strengthens/doubles this consonant.
קִ	Qof	k/q	Sheva is very short or silent here.
רַ	Resh	r	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 2

אלהים

Transliteration	Elohim	
Pronunciation	eh-lo-HEEM	
Meaning	God	
From / dictionary form	אלהים	Elohim - God

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Hatef Segol gives a quick 'eh' sound.
ל	Lamed	l	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ה	He (hay)	h	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
ם	Final Mem	m	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

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Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 3

לְאוֹר

Transliteration	la'or		
Pronunciation	lah-OR		
Meaning	to the light		
From / dictionary form	אוֹר	or -	light

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
לְ	Lamed	l	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
א	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.
יְ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ר	Resh	r	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

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Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 4

יוֹם

Transliteration	yom
Pronunciation	yohm
Meaning	day
From / dictionary form	יוֹם yom - day

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
יְ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ם	Final Mem	m	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

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Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 5

וְלַחֲשֹׁךְ

Transliteration	velachoshekh	
Pronunciation	veh-la-KHO-shekh	
Meaning	and the darkness	
From / dictionary form	חֹשֶׁךְ	choshekh - darkness

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
וְ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Sheva is very short or silent here.
לַ	Lamed	l	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
חֹ	Chet	kh	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
שֶׁ	Shin / Sin	sh	Segol gives the 'eh' sound. Right-hand Shin dot makes SH.
ךְ	Final Kaf	kh	Sheva is very short or silent here.

Copy:

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Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 6

קָרָא

Transliteration	qara		
Pronunciation	kah-RAH		
Meaning	He called / named		
From / dictionary form	קָרָא	qara - to call / proclaim / name	

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
קָ	Qof	k/q	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
רָ	Resh	r	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
אָ	Aleph	silent / carrier	Aleph carries/separates the vowel sound; it is usually silent.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 7

לילה

Transliteration	laylah
Pronunciation	LIE-lah
Meaning	night
From / dictionary form	לילה laylah - night

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
לְ	Lamed	l	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
יְ	Yod	y / helper	Sheva is very short or silent here.
לְ	Lamed	l	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
ה	He (hay)	h	He gives the H sound here unless silent at a word ending.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 8

וַיְהִי־עֶרֶב

Transliteration	vayehi-erev
Pronunciation	vai-yeh-HEE EH-rev
Meaning	and there was evening
From / dictionary form	עֶרֶב erev - evening

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
ַ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
יְ	Yod	y / helper	Sheva is very short or silent here.
הִ	He (hay)	h	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
—	Maqaf	no sound	Maqaf joins the words; it has no sound.
עֲ	Ayin	silent / throat	Segol gives the 'eh' sound.
רֶ	Resh	r	Segol gives the 'eh' sound.
ב	Bet	v	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 9

וַיְהִי־בֹקֶר

Transliteration	vayehi-voqer		
Pronunciation	vai-yeh-HEE VOH-ker		
Meaning	and there was morning		
From / dictionary form	בֹּקֶר	boqer - morning	

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
ַ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Patach gives the 'ah/a' sound.
ִ	Yod	y / helper	Sheva is very short or silent here.
ֶ	He (hay)	h	Hiriq gives the 'ee' sound.
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
־	Maqaf	no sound	Maqaf joins the words; it has no sound.
ֹ	Bet	v	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ֻ	Qof	k/q	Segol gives the 'eh' sound.
ר	Resh	r	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 10

יוֹם

Transliteration	yom
Pronunciation	yohm
Meaning	day
From / dictionary form	יוֹם yom - day

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
י	Yod	y / helper	Yod is Y here, or may help carry an 'ee' vowel.
יְ	Vav	v / vowel helper	Holam gives the 'oh' sound.
ם	Final Mem	m	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

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Genesis 1:5 - Word / Phrase 11

אֶחָד

Transliteration echad

Pronunciation eh-KHAHD

Meaning one

From / dictionary form אֶחָד echad - one

Letters and vowel marks

Letter	Name	Sound	What to notice
אֶ	Aleph	silent / carrier	Segol gives the 'eh' sound.
חֶ	Chet	kh	Qamatz usually gives the 'ah/a' sound.
דֶּ	Dalet	d	No vowel mark on this letter here.

Copy:

Write it yourself:

Genesis 1:5 - Put It All Together

Start at the RIGHT edge and move LEFT. Say the letter names and notice the vowel marks as you write.

וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹהִים לָאוֹר יוֹם וְלַחֹשֶׁךְ קִרְא לַיְלָה וַיְהיֶ֤עֶרֶב וַיְהיֶ֣בֶקֶר יוֹם אֶחָד׃

Pronunciation: vai-YIK-rah eh-lo-HEEM lah-OR yohm, veh-la-KHO-shekh kah-RAH LIE-lah; vai-yeh-HEE EH-rev, vai-yeh-HEE VOH-ker, yohm eh-KHAHD.

Meaning: And God called the light Day, and the darkness He called Night. And there was evening and there was morning, one day.

Copy the complete verse: